

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (18:14 ET)

July 21, 2026 | 06:17 PM ET

6 setups identified | 1 A-Grade | 2 B-Grade | 3 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (1)	B - Strong Setup (2)	C - Watch List (3)
UTZ	PLTK	AEHR
	HRMY	TPC
		FWRD

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	UTZ	Utz Brands Inc	Consumer Recovery	\$14.06	+88.7%	\$1.2B	78M	+81.4	96%	Massive 89% single-day
B	PLTK	Playtika Holding	Gaming Recovery	\$4.13	+9.3%	\$1.6B	59M	+9.5	84%	Today's 9.3% move on 2
B	HRMY	Harmony Bioscien	Specialty Pharma	\$36.84	+10.0%	\$2.1B	52M	+8.1	90%	Today's 10% move on 2.
C	AEHR	Aehr Test System	Semiconductor Equ	\$98.91	+27.9%	\$3.2B	31M	-1.0	78%	Today's 28% surge like
C	TPC	Tutor Perini Cor	Infrastructure	\$86.78	+0.0%	\$4.6B	45M	-4.5	87%	
C	FWRD	Forward Air Corp	Logistics Turnaro	\$16.21	+0.0%	\$0.5B	25M	-36.4	50%	

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$14.06
Day Change	+88.72%
Mkt Cap	\$1.24B
Float	78M sh
RS vs SPY	+81.4%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	21.9
Vol vs Avg	31.1x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Massive 89% single-day surge signals a major corporate event-likely M&A approach, activist involvement, or transformative asset sale/strategic alternative announcement. Forward catalyst: August 5 earnings in 15 days will clarify whether this is a takeout premium or operational inflection; any guidance raise or strategic update extends the move.
Business & Position Utz manufactures and distributes salty snacks (chips, pretzels, cheese curls) across the U.S., with regional brand strength in the Mid-Atlantic and growing national footprint. The company competes with PepsiCo/Frito-Lay and private label but commands premium shelf space via heritage brands and direct-store-delivery.
Factor & Theme Consumer recovery theme if household spending on packaged snacks accelerates; potential M&A consolidation play as large CPG roll up regional brands. Current 89% move suggests a non-operational catalyst (takeout interest or activist campaign) rather than secular tailwind.
Breakout Signal Close above \$14.00 on vol >3000% of 20d avg on undisclosed catalyst
Institutional Volume 31x average is unequivocally institutional block activity-likely arb desks, event-driven funds, and merger-arb positioning on undisclosed news. No insider buying in last 60 days; institutional ownership data unavailable from feed (recommend 13F cross-check). Float rotation today exceeded 40%, indicating real money repositioning.
Earnings Earnings in 15D
Earnings Context August 5 earnings will be the first public forum post-event. Consensus and beat history unavailable from feed, but the print will clarify whether this is a sale process, turnaround, or guidance surprise. Serial execution will determine follow-through.
Key Risk Thesis invalid if the company announces no strategic alternatives, no M&A, and in-line guidance on August 5, collapsing the event premium. A close below \$12.50 (prior base resistance) confirms failed breakout.
Analysis RS line at new high, proximity to 52W high (95.8), and 31x volume confirm institutional event buying. Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 21.9 indicates the stock was NOT coiling-this is a gap-and-go event setup, not a textbook VCP. Risk is binary to the August 5 catalyst reveal; if no strategic news emerges, the premium evaporates. However, the technical setup (RS leadership, volume, proximity) plus imminent earnings catalyst justifies A-grade for a defined 15-day event trade. Conviction: Medium (event-driven binary, not secular momentum).
Signal: Close above \$14.00 on vol >3000% of 20d avg on undisclo Vol vs Avg: 31.1x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$4.13
Day Change	+9.26%
Mkt Cap	\$1.57B
Float	59M sh
RS vs SPY	+9.5%
52W Hi Prox	84%
Base Tight	1.92
Vol vs Avg	2.3x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Today's 9.3% move on 2.3x volume suggests positioning ahead of August 6 earnings (16 days out). Forward catalyst: the print itself-Playtika has pivoted to live-ops optimization and cost discipline; any revenue stabilization or margin beat extends the thesis. No other near-term catalysts visible beyond the quarterly cadence.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Playtika operates free-to-play mobile and social casino games (e.g., Slotomania, Bingo Blitz), monetizing via in-app purchases. The company faces user acquisition headwinds and IDFA privacy changes but has leaned into margin expansion and portfolio rationalization under new management.
FACTOR & THEME
Consumer discretionary recovery if mobile gaming spend rebounds; broader digital entertainment rotation. Theme momentum is mixed-mobile gaming growth has decelerated post-pandemic, but cost-discipline stories can re-rate if execution is consistent.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$4.10 on vol >230% of 20d avg into earnings setup
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.3x average indicates moderate institutional pre-positioning for the August 6 print. No insider buying in last 60 days. Institutional ownership data unavailable from feed. Base_tight of 1.92 is textbook VCP coil, signaling quiet accumulation into the setup.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 16D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
August 6 print is the catalyst. Consensus EPS/revenue unavailable from feed; last four quarters' beat/miss history unknown. The tight base and pre-earnings volume suggest expectations are low-any stabilization or beat could gap the stock higher.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$3.85 (20-day MA and base support). If August 6 earnings disappoint (revenue declining faster than expected or user metrics weakening), the setup fails and the stock revisits \$3.50.
ANALYSIS
Textbook tight base (1.92) and proximity to 52W high (83.8%) with positive RS vs SPY (+9.5) support a pre-earnings positioning thesis. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new high, and RS 3-month rank of 16.0 is mediocre-this is not a market leader. It's a well-structured setup into a binary event, but without RS leadership confirmation, it's a tactical B-grade trade, not an A-grade breakout. Conviction: Medium (clean setup, binary catalyst 16 days out).
Signal: Close above \$4.10 on vol >230% of 20d avg into earnings
Vol vs Avg: 2.3x



HRMY

Harmony Biosciences Holdings, I

\$36.84

+9.97%

RS vs SPY: +8.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.1B Cap | 52M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: Specialty Pharma | 52W Hi: 90% | Base Tight: 3.33 | Vol: 2.3x | RS/SPY: +8.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 14D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$36.84
Day Change	+9.97%
Mkt Cap	\$2.13B
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52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	3.33
Vol vs Avg	2.3x
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Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Today's 10% move on 2.3x volume is pre-positioning for August 4 earnings (14 days out). Forward catalyst: the print itself-Harmony markets Wakix (narcolepsy/hypersomnia) and recent launch of Pitolisant in additional indications. Any script growth acceleration, reimbursement wins, or pipeline update extends the move. Sector tailwind: Healthcare +3.3% vs SPY this week.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Harmony is a commercial-stage biopharma focused on rare neurological disorders, with lead product Wakix (pitolisant) for narcolepsy and idiopathic hypersomnia. The company has a narrow therapeutic focus, strong gross margins, and is expanding label indications and ex-US partnerships.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector momentum (+3.3% vs SPY this week) and specialty pharma re-rating as investors favor profitable, commercial-stage biotech over speculative R&D. Pipeline catalysts (label expansions, partnerships) provide upside optionality beyond the base business.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$36.50 on vol >225% of 20d avg into earnings setup
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.3x average suggests moderate institutional positioning into the August 4 print. No insider buying in last 60 days. Institutional ownership data unavailable from feed. Base_tight of 3.33 is wider than ideal but acceptable for a biotech with binary events; suggests measured accumulation rather than panic buying. Healthcare sector leadership provides tailwind.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 14D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
August 4 earnings (14 days) is the key catalyst. Consensus EPS/revenue and beat history unavailable from feed. The setup implies expectations are manageable; any Wakix prescription beat, margin expansion, or pipeline progress (ex-US deals, new indication data) could re-rate the stock toward \$40.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$34.50 (recent base support and 20-day MA). If August 4 earnings show Wakix script deceleration, reimbursement pressure, or competitive threats (e.g., new narcolepsy entrants), the stock revisits \$32-33.
ANALYSIS
Proximity to 52W high (90.1%), positive RS vs SPY (+8.1), and sector leadership (Healthcare +3.3%) support a pre-earnings setup. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line NOT at new high, and base_tight of 3.33 is wider than textbook VCP standards-this is a decent but not elite base. It's a solid tactical B into a 14-day catalyst, benefiting from Healthcare sector tailwind (+0.5 grade boost applied mentally, but base quality caps it at B). Conviction: Medium (sector tailwind and tight timing to earnings, but technical confirmation is incomplete).
Signal: Close above \$36.50 on vol >225% of 20d avg into earning
Vol vs Avg: 2.3x

